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VEHICLE CONTROL DEVICE AND VEHICLE CONTROL METHOD

Abstract

A vehicle control device includes: a detector that detects a cyber-attack on an in-vehicle system provided in a vehicle; a determiner that determines whether a state of the in-vehicle system is an online state or an offline state when the cyber-attack is detected; and a controller that makes a behavior of the vehicle related to travelling of the vehicle different between a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determiner and a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner. The online state is a state in which communication is possible between the in-vehicle system and equipment outside the vehicle via a communication network, and the offline state is a state in which such communication is not possible.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] The present application is based on and claims priority of Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-029692 filed on Feb. 29, 2024.

FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a vehicle control device provided in a vehicle.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Conventionally, an information processing device has been proposed as a vehicle control device to be provided in a vehicle (see, for example, Patent Literature (PTL) 1). This information processing device checks whether wireless communication is possible between the vehicle and a security center. Then, when security event information corresponding to a cyber-attack occurs within the vehicle, if wireless communication thereof is possible, the information processing device transmits the security event information to the security center. As a result, the information processing device obtains response instructions corresponding to the security event information from the security center. On the other hand, when the security event information occurs, if wireless communication is not possible, the information processing device notifies the inside of the vehicle of response instructions that are predetermined according to the security event information.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

[0004] PTL 1: Japanese Unexamined Patent Application Publication No. 2023-39790

SUMMARY

[0005] However, the information processing device according to PTL 1 can be improved upon.

[0006] In view of this, the present disclosure provides a vehicle control device and the like capable of improving upon the above related art.

[0007] A vehicle control device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure includes: a detector that detects a cyber-attack on an in-vehicle system provided in a vehicle; a determiner that determines whether a state of the in-vehicle system is an online state or an offline state when the cyber-attack is detected; and a controller that makes a behavior of the vehicle related to travelling of the vehicle different between a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determiner and a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner, wherein the online state is a state in which communication is possible between the in-vehicle system and equipment outside the vehicle via a communication network, and the offline state is a state in which communication is not possible between the in-vehicle system and the equipment via the communication network.

[0008] It should be noted that these comprehensive or specific aspects may be realized by a system, a method, an integrated circuit, a computer program, or a recording medium such as a computer-readable CD-ROM, or may be realized by any combination of a system, a method, an integrated circuit, a computer program, and a recording medium. In addition, the recording medium may be a non-transitory recording medium.

[0009] The vehicle control device of the present disclosure is capable of improving upon the above related art.

[0010] It should be noted that further advantages and effects of one aspect of the present disclosure

will become apparent from the specification and drawings. Such advantages and/or effects are provided by some of the embodiments and configurations described in the specification and drawings, but not all of the configurations are necessarily required.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0011] These and other advantages and features of the present disclosure will become apparent from the following description thereof taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings that illustrate a specific embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of a management system in an embodiment.

[0013] FIG. 2 is a block diagram showing a configuration example of an in-vehicle system in the embodiment.

[0014] FIG. 3 is a block diagram showing a configuration example of a vehicle control device in the embodiment.

[0015] FIG. 4 is a diagram showing an example of a behavior of vehicle V when the state of the in-vehicle system in the embodiment is online.

[0016] FIG. 5 is a diagram showing an example of a behavior of vehicle V when the state of the in-vehicle system in the embodiment is offline.

[0017] FIG. 6 is a diagram for explaining the operation of the surrounding notifier in the embodiment.

[0018] FIG. 7 is a flowchart showing an example of the processing operation of the vehicle control device in the embodiment.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENT

(Underlying Knowledge Forming Basis of the Present Disclosure)

[0019] The present inventor has discovered that the following problem arises with the information processing device of PTL 1 described in the “Background” section.

[0020] In the information processing device of PTL 1, the method of obtaining and notifying response instructions differs depending on whether wireless communication is possible or not. However, whether wireless communication is possible or not, it is conceivable that the vehicle may be forcibly stopped when it is subjected to a cyber-attack. If the vehicle is forcibly stopped when wireless communication is not possible, the information processing device of PTL 1 notifies the inside of the vehicle of response instructions prepared in advance. This makes it difficult to take more appropriate measures against cyber-attacks while communicating with a security center outside the vehicle. That is, the information processing device of PTL 1 has a problem in that it is difficult to implement appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on the vehicle. In other words, the information processing device of PTL 1 has a problem in that it is insufficient to provide appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on the vehicle.

[0021] In order to solve such a problem, a vehicle control device according to Aspect 1 of the present disclosure includes: a detector that detects a cyber-attack on an in-vehicle system provided in a vehicle; a determiner that determines whether a state of the in-vehicle system is an online state or an offline state when the cyber-attack is detected; and a controller that makes a behavior of the vehicle related to travelling of the vehicle different between a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determiner and a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner, wherein the online state is a state in which communication is possible between the in-vehicle system and equipment outside the vehicle via a communication network, and the offline state is a state in which communication is not possible between the in-vehicle system and the equipment via the communication network.

[0022] Accordingly, when a cyber-attack is detected, the behavior related to travelling of the

vehicle differs depending on whether the state of the in-vehicle system is online or offline.

Therefore, when the state of the in-vehicle system is online, the vehicle can be caused at that time to execute a behavior that is capable of implementing appropriate measures against a cyber-attack using the communication described above and that is safe. On the other hand, when the state of the in-vehicle system is offline, for example, the vehicle can be caused to execute a behavior that is likely to switch its state to online and is safe. In addition, once the state of the in-vehicle system switches to online, appropriate measures using communication can be implemented against a cyber-attack, as mentioned above. In this way, the vehicle control device of Aspect 1 can implement appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on the vehicle.

[0023] In addition, in a vehicle control device according to Aspect 2, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determination process, the controller may stop the vehicle as the behavior of the vehicle. It should be noted that Aspect 2 may depend from Aspect 1.

[0024] Accordingly, when the in-vehicle system is online, the vehicle will be stopped, so that at that point appropriate measures using communication mentioned above can be implemented against cyber-attacks and the safety of the vehicle can be ensured.

[0025] In addition, in the vehicle control device according to Aspect 3, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner, the controller may cause the vehicle to travel in a fallback operation as the behavior of the vehicle. It should be noted that Aspect 3 may depend from Aspect 1 or Aspect 2. In addition, in the fallback operation, for example, the maximum speed is limited to a speed slower than that in normal driving.

[0026] Accordingly, when the in-vehicle system is offline, the vehicle travels in the fallback operation, so that the vehicle can be safely moved from an offline area to an online area. As a result, it is possible to increase the likelihood that the in-vehicle system will switch from offline to online, and ensure the safety of the vehicle.

[0027] In addition, in the vehicle control device according to Aspect 4, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to have switched from the offline state to the online state by the determiner, the controller may stop the vehicle by causing the vehicle to stop travelling in the fallback operation. It should be noted that Aspect 4 may depend from Aspect 3 which depends from Aspect 1 or Aspect 2.

[0028] Accordingly, when the state of the in-vehicle system switches from offline to online, the vehicle will be stopped, so that at that point appropriate measures using communication mentioned above can be implemented against cyber-attacks and the safety of the vehicle can be ensured.

[0029] In addition, in a vehicle control device according to Aspect 5, the vehicle control device further includes a surrounding notifier that notifies a surrounding of the vehicle that the vehicle is being subjected to the cyber-attack, and when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner, the controller may further cause the surrounding notifier to notify the surrounding that the vehicle is being subjected to the cyber-attack. It should be noted that Aspect 5 may depend from any one of Aspect 1 to Aspect 4. It should be noted that the surrounding notifier notifies people or other vehicles around the vehicle that the vehicle is being subjected to a cyber-attack by flashing headlights or hazard lights of the vehicle, or by wireless communication such as vehicle-to-vehicle communication.

[0030] Accordingly, people or other vehicles around the vehicle can know that the vehicle is being subjected to a cyber-attack, specifically, that the in-vehicle system provided in the vehicle is being subjected to cyber-attack. As a result, people or other vehicles around the vehicle can act safely.

[0031] In addition, in the vehicle control device according to Aspect 6, the detector may further detect a malfunction of the in-vehicle system, and regardless of a detection result of the cyber-attack, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determiner and the malfunction of the in-vehicle system is detected by the detector, the controller may cause the vehicle to travel in a fallback operation, and when the state of the in-vehicle system

is determined to have switched from the offline state to the online state by the determiner, the controller may cause the in-vehicle system to report the malfunction of the in-vehicle system to the equipment. It should be noted that Aspect 6 may depend from any one of Aspect 1 to Aspect 5. [0032] Accordingly, even if a malfunction occurs in the vehicle to the extent that the vehicle is capable of travelling in a fallback operation, the vehicle can be safely moved from an offline area to an online area, just as when a cyber-attack is detected and the state of the in-vehicle system is offline. When the state of the in-vehicle system switches from offline to online, the malfunction is reported using the above-mentioned communication, so that the in-vehicle system and vehicle can be properly restored.

[0033] Furthermore, in the vehicle control device according to Aspect 7, when the controller causes the vehicle to travel in a fallback operation as the behavior of the vehicle, the controller may stop a safety function related to the travelling of the vehicle, and notify an occupant of the vehicle that the safety function has been stopped, by controlling a human machine interface (HMI) provided in the vehicle. It should be noted that Aspect 7 may depend from Aspect 3 or any one of Aspect 4 to Aspect 6 which depends from Aspect 3.

[0034] Accordingly, the safety functions of the vehicle are stopped, so that the processing burden on the vehicle can be reduced. Furthermore, even if the safety functions are stopped, the occupants are notified of this, so that the safety can be ensured.

[0035] Hereinafter, an embodiment will be described in detail with reference to the drawings.

[0036] It should be noted that each of the embodiments described below shows a comprehensive or specific example. The numerical values, shapes, materials, components, the arrangement and connection forms of the components, steps, and the order of steps shown in the following embodiments are merely examples and are not intended to limit the present disclosure. In addition, among the components in the following embodiments, the components that are not described in the independent claims that indicates the broadest concept are described as arbitrary components. In addition, each figure is a schematic view and is not necessarily exactly illustrated. In addition, in each figure, the same components are given the same reference numerals.

EMBODIMENT

[0037] FIG. 1 is a diagram showing an example of a management system in the present embodiment.

[0038] Management system **1000** is, for example, a system for monitoring or managing the security of vehicle V. In-vehicle system **100** for, for example, automatically driving vehicle V is provided in vehicle V. In a specific example, in-vehicle system **100** is configured with a controller area network (CAN) or the like. Management system **1000** in the present embodiment includes in-vehicle system **100** and management server **200** that can communicate with each other via communication network Nt. It should be noted that, in the present embodiment, management system **1000** includes one in-vehicle system **100**, but the number of in-vehicle systems **100** included in management system **1000** is not limited to one and may be multiple.

[0039] In-vehicle system **100** collects information related to security within in-vehicle system **100** and transmits the information to management server **200**, for example, via one or more base stations and communication network Nt.

[0040] When management server **200** obtains the information related to security mentioned above from in-vehicle system **100** of vehicle V, management server **200** determines the risk level of in-vehicle system **100**, i.e., the risk level of vehicle V on which in-vehicle system **100** is mounted, based on the information. Then, based on the determined risk level, management server **200** transmits information related to security measures to in-vehicle system **100** via one or more base stations and communication network Nt.

[0041] When in-vehicle system **100** obtains information related to security measures from management server **200**, in-vehicle system **100** presents the security measures to, for example, the occupants in vehicle V. In addition, in-vehicle system **100** may automatically execute the security

measures.

[0042] FIG. 2 is a block diagram showing a configuration example of in-vehicle system **100** in the present embodiment.

[0043] In-vehicle system **100** includes vehicle control device **110**, communicator **120**, and n (n is an integer greater than or equal to 1) electronic control units (ECUs) **130**. It should be noted that in-vehicle system **100** may further include other components.

[0044] n ECUs **130** perform, for example, vehicle speed control, steering angle control, opening and closing of doors or glass windows, air conditioning control, and the like of vehicle **V**.

[0045] Communicator **120** performs wireless communication with management server **200** via one or more base stations and communication network **Nt**. The method of this wireless communication is not particularly limited and may be any method.

[0046] Vehicle control device **110** monitors a cyber-attack on in-vehicle system **100**, and switches the behavior related to travelling of vehicle **V** by controlling, for example, n ECUs **130** according to the wireless communication state of communicator **120**. It should be noted that vehicle control device **110** may be configured as an ECU, or may be configured from a plurality of ECUs.

[0047] FIG. 3 is a block diagram showing a configuration example of vehicle control device **110**.

[0048] Vehicle control device **110** includes controller **111**, determiner **112**, detector **113**, and surrounding notifier **114**.

[0049] Detector **113** detects a cyber-attack on in-vehicle system **100** provided in vehicle **V**. For example, detector **113** detects a cyber-attack on in-vehicle system **100** by monitoring information such as messages communicated among n ECUs **130**. For example, detector **113** detects a cyber-attack when n ECUs **130** are behaving differently from normal. More specifically, detector **113** detects a cyber-attack when messages communicated among n ECUs **130** have predetermined characteristics that differ from normal messages. Alternatively, detector **113** detects a cyber-attack when the amount or number of messages transmitted is greater or less than a predetermined range.

[0050] It should be noted that when a cyber-attack is made on in-vehicle system **100** via communication, detector **113** may detect the cyber-attack, or after the cyber-attack has been made, detector **113** may detect the cyber-attack. That is, detector **113** detects a cyber-attack regardless of whether in-vehicle system **100** is in an online or offline state, as mentioned below. For example, a cyber-attack is made when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online. Then, when some time has passed since the cyber-attack was made, or when a specific mode is activated in in-vehicle system **100**, the cyber-attack is detected by detector **113**. Therefore, at the time when the cyber-attack is detected, the state of in-vehicle system **100** may be offline.

[0051] When a cyber-attack is detected, determiner **112** determines whether the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online or offline. Here, online is a state in which communication via communication network **Nt** is possible between communicator **120** of in-vehicle system **100** and management server **200**. Offline is a state in which communication via communication network **Nt** is not possible between communicator **120** of in-vehicle system **100** and management server **200**. It should be noted that management server **200** is an example of equipment outside vehicle **V**. That is, if wireless communication is possible between communicator **120** and management server **200**, determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** or vehicle **V** is online. On the other hand, if wireless communication is not possible between communicator **120** and management server **200**, determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** or vehicle **V** is offline. In a specific example, if the radio wave strength transmitted from the base station in response to the output signal from management server **200** is greater than or equal to a threshold, determiner **112** determines that wireless communication is possible, and if the radio wave strength is less than the threshold, it determines that wireless communication is impossible.

[0052] Surrounding notifier **114** notifies the surroundings of vehicle **V** that it is being subjected to a cyber-attack. For example, surrounding notifier **114** notifies the surroundings of vehicle **V** that it is being subjected to a cyber-attack by, for example, blinking the headlights and hazard lights of

vehicle V. That is, surrounding notifier **114** notifies people or other vehicles around vehicle V. The range around vehicle V may be, for example, a range in which vehicle V is visible to the human eye, or may be a predetermined range such as a range within a radius of 10 m from vehicle V. In addition, surrounding notifier **114** may notify other vehicles parked or travelling around vehicle V by wireless communication. This notification by wireless communication is a notification that is performed directly between vehicle V and other vehicles via no communication network Nt, and is also called a notification by vehicle-to-vehicle communication (i.e., V2V). In addition, Bluetooth (registered trademark) or the like may be used as a method of vehicle-to-vehicle communication. [0053] Controller **111** makes the behavior of vehicle V related to travelling of vehicle V different between a case where determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online and a case where determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline. That is, controller **111** makes the behavior related to travelling of vehicle V different by controlling n ECUs **130**.

[0054] Accordingly, when a cyber-attack is detected, the behavior related to travelling of the vehicle differs depending on whether the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online or offline. Therefore, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online, vehicle V can be caused at that time to execute a behavior that is capable of implementing appropriate measures against a cyber-attack using communication and that is safe. It should be noted that the appropriate measures using communication are measures using communication via communication network Nt between in-vehicle system **100** and management server **200**. In addition, the behavior is, for example, stopping, as mentioned below.

[0055] On the other hand, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline, for example, vehicle V can be caused to execute a behavior that is likely to switch its state to online and is safe. It should be noted that such behavior is, for example, travelling in a fallback operation, as mentioned below. In addition, if the state of in-vehicle system **100** is switched to online as a result of such behavior, appropriate measures using communications can be implemented against cyber-attacks. In this way, vehicle control device **110** according to the present embodiment can implement appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on vehicle V.

[0056] FIG. **4** is a diagram showing an example of the behavior of vehicle V when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online.

[0057] If determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online when a cyber-attack is detected, controller **111** causes vehicle V to stop as a behavior of vehicle V. For example, controller **111** forcibly stops vehicle V regardless of whether the driver of vehicle V is manually driving the vehicle. Controller **111** then collects information related to the cyber-attack as the information related to security mentioned above, and causes communicator **120** to transmit the information to management server **200**. That is, controller **111** causes communicator **120** to report to management server **200**. The information related to the cyber-attack includes the fact that the cyber-attack was subjected to, the details of the cyber-attack, and a request for measures against the cyber-attack (i.e., security measures).

[0058] In response to the report, communicator **120** obtains information related to the security measures from management server **200** via communication network Nt. As a result, controller **111** presents the security measures to, for example, the occupants of vehicle V. Specifically, controller **111** displays an image showing the security measures on the display of vehicle V. In addition, controller **111** may automatically execute the security measures by controlling n ECUs **130**. This makes it possible to implement appropriate measures against the cyber-attack.

[0059] In this way, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online, vehicle V is stopped, so that at that point appropriate measures using communication mentioned above can be implemented against the cyber-attack and the safety of vehicle V can be ensured.

[0060] FIG. **5** is a diagram showing an example of the behavior of vehicle V when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline.

[0061] When determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline when a cyber-attack is detected, controller **111** causes vehicle V to travel in a fallback operation as the behavior of vehicle V. For example, as shown in FIG. 5, determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline when vehicle V is travelling in a place where radio waves from a base station are difficult to reach, such as a mountainous area. It should be noted that determiner **112** may also determine that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline when vehicle V is travelling in a tunnel or the like. Then, unlike when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online, controller **111** causes vehicle V to travel in a fallback operation as mentioned above, without forcibly stopping vehicle V. The fallback operation is a mode in which the functions or performance of in-vehicle system **100** or vehicle V are partially suppressed. In a specific example, the fallback operation limits the maximum speed of vehicle V. For example, even if the maximum speed of vehicle V is 180 km/h, in the fallback operation, the maximum speed is limited to 10 km/h. That is, controller **111** causes vehicle V to continue travelling at a low speed without stopping.

[0062] In this way, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline, vehicle V travels in a fallback operation, so that vehicle V can be safely moved from an offline area to an online area. As a result, the possibility that in-vehicle system **100** will switch from offline to online can be increased, and the safety of vehicle V can be ensured.

[0063] Then, when determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** has switched from offline to online, controller **111** stops vehicle V by causing vehicle V to stop travelling in the fallback operation. That is, when vehicle V moves from an offline area to an online area by travelling in the fallback operation, controller **111**, as in the example of FIG. 4, for example, forcibly stops vehicle V regardless of manual driving by the driver of vehicle V. Then, controller **111** causes communicator **120** to execute a report to management server **200**.

[0064] In response to the report, communicator **120** obtains information related to security measures from management server **200** via communication network Nt. As a result, controller **111** presents the security measures to, for example, the occupants of vehicle V. In addition, controller **111** may automatically execute the security measures by controlling n ECUs **130**. This makes it possible to implement appropriate measures against the cyber-attack.

[0065] In this way, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** switches from offline to online, vehicle V stops, so that at that point appropriate measures using communication mentioned above can be implemented against the cyber-attack and the safety of vehicle V can be ensured.

[0066] FIG. 6 is a diagram for explaining the operation of surrounding notifier **114**.

[0067] If determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline when a cyber-attack is detected, controller **111** further causes surrounding notifier **114** to notify the surroundings that in-vehicle system **100** is being subjected to a cyber-attack. For example, surrounding notifier **114** notifies the surroundings of vehicle V by blinking the headlights and hazard lights of vehicle V, and further notifies the surroundings of vehicle V by vehicle-to-vehicle communication. In addition, if determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** has switched from offline to online, controller **111** stops vehicle V and causes communicator **120** to report to management server **200**. At this time, controller **111** may also cause surrounding notifier **114** to notify the surroundings that in-vehicle system **100** is being subjected to a cyber-attack.

[0068] In this way, people or other vehicles around vehicle V can know that vehicle V is being subjected to a cyber-attack, specifically, that in-vehicle system **100** provided in vehicle V is being subjected to a cyber-attack. As a result, people or other vehicles around it can act safely.

[0069] FIG. 7 is a flowchart showing an example of the processing operation of vehicle control device **110** in the present embodiment.

[0070] First, detector **113** of vehicle control device **110** detects whether in-vehicle system **100** has been subjected to a cyber-attack (step S1). Here, if detector **113** detects that in-vehicle system **100** has not been subjected to a cyber-attack (No in step S1), detector **113** repeats the process of step

S1. On the other hand, if detector **113** detects a cyber-attack (Yes in step **S1**), determiner **112** determines whether the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline (step **S2**).

[0071] Here, when determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is not offline, i.e., online (No in step **S2**), controller **111** causes vehicle **V** to execute a first behavior (step **S3**). The first behavior is, for example, the stopping of the vehicle **V** mentioned above. On the other hand, when determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline (Yes in step **S2**), controller **111** causes vehicle **V** to execute a second behavior (step **S4**). The second behavior is, for example, the travelling of vehicle **V** in a fallback operation mentioned above.

[0072] After the process of step **S4**, determiner **112** determines whether the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online (step **S5**). That is, determiner **112** determines whether the state has switched from offline to online. Here, if determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is not online, i.e., has not switched to online (No in step **S5**), controller **111** continues to execute the process of step **S4**. On the other hand, if determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online, i.e., has switched to online (Yes in step **S5**), controller **111** executes the process of step **S3**. That is, controller **111** causes vehicle **V** to execute the first behavior.

[0073] In this way, vehicle control device **110** in the present embodiment can implement appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on vehicle **V**.

[0074] While the vehicle control device and vehicle control method of the present disclosure have been described above based on the embodiment described above, the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiment described above. Forms obtained by applying various modifications to the embodiment conceived by a person skilled in the art without departing from the spirit of the present disclosure may also be included in the present disclosure.

[0075] For example, in the embodiment described above, vehicle control device **110** makes the behavior of vehicle **V** related to travelling of vehicle **V** different depending on whether the state of in-vehicle system **100** is online or offline when a cyber-attack is detected, but also when a malfunction is detected, the same processing operation may be performed. Specifically, detector **113** further detects a malfunction in in-vehicle system **100**. Then, regardless of the detection result of the cyber-attack, when determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline and detector **113** detects a malfunction in in-vehicle system **100**, controller **111** causes vehicle **V** to travel in a fallback operation. In addition, when determiner **112** determines that the state of in-vehicle system **100** has switched from offline to online, controller **111** causes in-vehicle system **100** to report the malfunction in in-vehicle system **100** to management server **200**. That is, controller **111** causes communicator **120** of in-vehicle system **100** to report the malfunction. It should be noted that the malfunction may be a malfunction in vehicle **V**. In addition, at this time, controller **111** may use a display, a speaker, or the like within vehicle **V** to notify the occupants of vehicle **V** recommending that they contact the dealer of vehicle **V**.

[0076] Accordingly, even if a malfunction occurs in vehicle **V** to the extent that vehicle **V** is capable of travelling in a fallback operation, vehicle **V** can be safely moved from an offline area to an online area, just as when a cyber-attack is detected and the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline. When the state of in-vehicle system **100** switches from offline to online, the malfunction is automatically reported, so that in-vehicle system **100** and vehicle **V** can be properly restored.

[0077] In addition, in the embodiment described above, vehicle control device **110** is included in in-vehicle system **100**, but it does not have to be included in in-vehicle system **100**. In addition, in the embodiment described above, vehicle control device **110** is configured as an ECU, but it does not have to be configured as an ECU.

[0078] In addition, in the embodiment described above, when the state of in-vehicle system **100** is offline, travelling in a fallback operation is performed as the second behavior of vehicle **V**, but the second behavior is not limited to travelling in a fallback operation and may be another behavior.

[0079] In addition, in the fallback operation, the maximum speed of vehicle **V** is limited, but other parameters or functions of vehicle **V** may be limited. For example, in the fallback operation, in

addition to limiting the maximum speed, a safety function such as autonomous emergency braking (AEB) may be stopped. In addition, when the safety function is stopped, controller **111** may notify the occupants of vehicle V that the safety function has been stopped, by using a human machine interface (HMI) in vehicle V. For example, controller **111** displays a message such as “AEB is stopped” on a display. Alternatively, controller **111** outputs the message by voice from a speaker. It should be noted that a display, a speaker, and the like are examples of an HMI. In this way, when controller **111** causes vehicle V to perform travelling in a fallback operation as the behavior of vehicle V, controller **111** stops the safety functions related to the travelling of vehicle V and notifies the occupants of vehicle V that the safety functions have been stopped, by controlling the HMI provided in vehicle V. Accordingly, the safety functions of vehicle V are stopped, so that the processing load on vehicle V can be reduced. Furthermore, even if the safety functions are stopped, the occupants are notified of it and the maximum speed is restricted, so that the safety can be ensured.

[0080] It should be noted that in the embodiment described above, each component may be configured with a dedicated circuit or hardware, or may be realized by executing a software program suitable for each component. Each component may be realized by a program executor such as a central processing unit (CPU) or processor reading and executing a software program recorded on a recording medium such as a hard disk or semiconductor memory. Here, the program, which is software that realizes the device or system of the embodiment described above, causes a computer to execute each step included in the flowchart in FIG. 7.

[0081] It should be noted that the following cases are also included in the present disclosure:

[0082] (1) The device or system described above may specifically be a computer system including a microprocessor, read only memory (ROM), random access memory (RAM), a hard disk unit, a display unit, a keyboard, a mouse, and the like. A computer program is stored in the RAM or hard disk unit. The device or system described above achieves its functions by the microprocessor operating in accordance with the computer program. Here, a computer program is a combination of a plurality of instruction codes that indicate commands to a computer to achieve a predetermined function. [0083] (2) Some or all of the components included in the device or system described above may be included in a single system large scale integration (LSI). A system LSI is an ultra-multifunctional LSI manufactured by integrating a plurality of components on a single chip, and specifically, is a computer system including a microprocessor, ROM, RAM, and the like. A computer program is stored in the RAM. The system LSI achieves its functions by the microprocessor operating in accordance with the computer program. [0084] (3) Some or all of the components included in the device or system described above may be included in an IC card or a stand-alone module that can be attached to or detached from the device or system. The IC card or module is a computer system including a microprocessor, ROM, RAM, and the like. The IC card or module may include the ultra-multifunction LSI described above. The IC card or module achieves its functions by the microprocessor operating in accordance with a computer program. This IC card or module may be tamper-resistant. [0085] (4) The present disclosure may include a method corresponding to the device or system described above. In addition, the present disclosure may include a computer program for implementing such a method by a computer, or a digital signal consisting of a computer program.

[0086] In addition, the present disclosure may be a computer-readable recording medium having recorded thereon a computer program or a digital signal, such as a flexible disk, a hard disk, a compact disc (CD)-ROM, a DVD, a DVD-ROM, a DVD-RAM, a Blu-ray disc (registered trademark) (BD), semiconductor memory, or the like. In addition, the present disclosure may be a digital signal recorded on such a recording medium.

[0087] In addition, the present disclosure may include transmitting a computer program or a digital signal via a telecommunications line, a wireless or wired communication line, a network such as the Internet, data broadcasting, or the like.

[0088] In addition, the program or digital signal may be implemented by another independent computer system by recording the program or digital signal on a recording medium and transferring it, or by transferring the program or digital signal via a network or the like.

[0089] While various embodiments have been described herein above, it is to be appreciated that various changes in form and detail may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure as presently or hereafter claimed.

Further Information about Technical Background to this Application

[0090] The disclosure of the following patent application including specification, drawings, and claims is incorporated herein by reference in their entirety: Japanese Patent Application No. 2024-029692 filed on Feb. 29, 2024.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

[0091] The vehicle control device of the present disclosure can implement appropriate measures against cyber-attacks on a vehicle, and can be applied, for example, to devices, systems, or the like provided in a vehicle.

Claims

1. A vehicle control device comprising: memory; and a processor connected to the memory, wherein the processor executes: a detection process for detecting a cyber-attack on an in-vehicle system provided in a vehicle; a determination process for determining whether a state of the in-vehicle system is an online state or an offline state when the cyber-attack is detected; and a control process for making a behavior of the vehicle related to travelling of the vehicle different between a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determination process and a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determination process, and the online state is a state in which communication is possible between the in-vehicle system and equipment outside the vehicle via a communication network, and the offline state is a state in which communication is not possible between the in-vehicle system and the equipment via the communication network.
2. The vehicle control device according to claim 1, wherein in the control process, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state by the determination process, the processor stops the vehicle as the behavior of the vehicle.
3. The vehicle control device according to claim 1, wherein in the control process, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determination process, the processor causes the vehicle to travel in a fallback operation as the behavior of the vehicle.
4. The vehicle control device according to claim 3, wherein in the control process, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to have switched from the offline state to the online state by the determination process, the processor stops the vehicle by causing the vehicle to stop travelling in the fallback operation.
5. The vehicle control device according to claim 1, wherein in the control process, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determination process, the processor further notifies a surrounding of the vehicle that the vehicle is being subjected to the cyber-attack.
6. The vehicle control device according to claim 1, wherein in the detection process, the processor further detects a malfunction of the in-vehicle system, and in the control process, regardless of a detection result of the cyber-attack, when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state by the determination process and the malfunction of the in-vehicle system is detected by the detection process, the processor causes the vehicle to travel in a fallback operation, and when the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to have switched from the offline state to the online state by the determination process, the processor causes the in-vehicle system to report the malfunction of the in-vehicle system to the equipment.

7. The vehicle control device according to claim 3, wherein in the control process, when the processor causes the vehicle to travel in the fallback operation as the behavior of the vehicle, the processor stops a safety function related to the travelling of the vehicle, and notifies an occupant of the vehicle that the safety function has been stopped, by controlling a human machine interface (HMI) provided in the vehicle.

8. A vehicle control method by which a computer controls a vehicle, the vehicle control method comprising: detecting a cyber-attack on an in-vehicle system provided in a vehicle; determining whether a state of the in-vehicle system is an online state or an offline state when the cyber-attack is detected; and making a behavior of the vehicle related to travelling of the vehicle different between a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the online state and a case where the state of the in-vehicle system is determined to be the offline state, wherein the online state is a state in which communication is possible between the in-vehicle system and equipment outside the vehicle via a communication network, and the offline state is a state in which communication is not possible between the in-vehicle system and the equipment via the communication network.
